

That thou mayest be forgiven all (thy) transgressions ;
(and) thy sins of ignorance.

And may He strengthen thee,
And bless thee.

And mayest thou inherit the whole earth,

15. And may He renew His covenant with thee,
That thou mayest be to Him a nation for His inheritance
for all the ages,
And that He may be to thee and to thy seed a God in
truth and righteousness throughout all the days of
the earth.

16. And do thou, my son Jacob, remember my words,
And observe the commandments of Abraham, thy father :
Separate thyself from the nations,
And eat not with them :
And do not according to their works,
And become not their associate ;
For their works are unclean,
And all their ways are a pollution and an abomination
and uncleanness.

17. They offer their sacrifices to the dead

Thou mayest be forgiven. Lat. = "He may forgive." The "thy" and "and" are supplied from the Latin.

15. *Renew His covenant.* See ver. 30.

Nation for His inheritance. See on ver. 9.

16. The exclusiveness of Judaism is here traced to Abraham. The very existence of Judaism in 200-150 B.C. made such exclusiveness indispensable.

Separate thyself from the nations. Cf. Is. lii. 11.

Eat not with them. A Jew could not eat with a Gentile ; for the animals might not have been slaughtered according to the prescriptions of the Law (Deut. xii. 23, 24) or might have been amongst those that were forbidden to the Jew (Lev. xi. 4-7, 10-12, 13-20) or the meat and wine might have been offered to idols (cf. 1 Cor. x. 20, 27-

29). Antiochus IV. tried to force the Jews to eat of unclean food, 1 Macc. i. 47-48, 62-63 ; 2 Macc. vi. 18-21, vii. 1. See Driver's Commentary on Daniel i. 8-10 note. Cf. Matt. ix. 11 ; Mk. ii. 16 for the Pharisaic attitude.

Their ways are a pollution. Cf. ver. 19. Observe how frequently this conception returns in all accounts of the persecution of Antiochus Epiphanes and his successors : *μιαίνειν* in 1 Macc. i. 46, 63, iv. 45, vii. 34, xiv. 36 ; *μασμός*, 1 Macc. iv. 43 ; *ἀκάθαρτος*, 1 Macc. i. 48, iv. 43 ; *ἀκαθαρσία*, 1 Macc. xiii. 48, xiv. 7 ; *μύσος*, 2 Macc. vi. 19, 25 ; *μολύνω*, 1 Macc. i. 37 ; 2 Macc. vi. 2, xiv. 3 ; *μολυσμός*, 2 Macc. v. 27 ; *βεβήλω*, 1 Macc. i. 43, 45, 48, 63, ii. 12, 34, iii. 51, etc. ; *βεβήλωσις*, 1 Macc. i. 48.

17. *Offer their sacrifices to the dead.* Cf. Deut. xxvi. 14 ; Ps. cvi. 28 ; Sir. vii.

And they worship evil spirits,
 And they eat over the graves,
 And all their works are vanity and nothingness.

18. They have no heart to understand
 And their eyes do not see what their works are,
 And how they err in saying to a piece of wood: 'Thou
 art my God,'
 And to a stone: 'Thou art my Lord and thou art my
 deliverer.'
 [And they have no heart.]

19. And as for thee, my son Jacob,
 May the Most High God help thee
 And the God of heaven bless thee
 And remove thee from their uncleanness and from all
 their error.

20. Be thou ware, my son Jacob, of taking a wife from any
 seed of the daughters of Canaan;
 For all his seed is to be rooted out of the earth.

21. For, owing to the transgression of Ham, Canaan erred,
 And all his seed will be destroyed from off the earth
 and all the residue thereof,

33; Tob. iv. 17, which allude to such sacrifices as being offered by Israel. They are derided Sir. xxx. 18, 19; Ep. Jer. 31, 32; Wisdom xiv. 15, xix. 3; Or. Sibyl. viii. 382-384. The Pirke Aboth iii. 4 speaks of "sacrifices to the dead" (ובתי המתים).

Worship evil spirits. Some of the Jews at the bidding of Antiochus Epiphanes consented to worship idols and offer them sacrifices, 1 Macc. i. 43. For other references to such worship generally see Deut. xxxii. 17; Lev. xvii. 7; Ps. cvi. 37; Eth. Enoch xix. 1; Baruch iv. 7; 1 Cor. x. 20: ἀλλ' ὅτι ἃ θύουσιν τὰ ἔθνη, δαίμονιαις . . . θύουσιν. See note on i. 11-13 of our text.

Eat over the graves. Just as the worshipper of Yahweh partook of the sacrifices offered to Him, so those who

offered sacrifices to the dead partook of such sacrifices. These sacrifices were placed over the grave: see references given under "offer sacrifices to the dead" in earlier part of the verse: also Schwally, *Das Leben nach dem Tode*, 21-24.

18. Cf. xii. 5, xx. 8; Jer. ii. 27.

Their works. Read gebrômû instead of gabrômû in my text.

[*And they have no heart*]. Bracketed as a dittography of the beginning of ver. 18. The parallelism is against it.

20. Cf. Gen. xxviii. 1. For similar commands see xxv. 5, xxvii. 10, xxx 7 of our text; Test. Levi 9.

For all his seed, etc. This line recurs in ver. 21^b; for the two Ethiopic verbs are not infrequently renderings of the same word in Greek.

And none springing from him will be saved on the day of judgment.

22. And as for all the worshippers of idols and the profane
(b) There will be no hope for them in the land of the living;

(e) And there will be no remembrance of them on the earth;

(c) For they will descend into Sheol,

(d) And into the place of condemnation will they go,

As the children of Sodom were taken away from the earth
So will all those who worship idols be taken away.

23. Fear not, my son Jacob,

And be not dismayed, O son of Abraham:

May the Most High God preserve thee from destruction,
And from all the paths of error may He deliver thee.

24. This house have I built for myself that I might put my name upon it in the earth: [it is given to thee and to thy seed for ever], and it will be named the house of Abraham; it is given to thee and to thy seed for ever; for thou wilt build my house and establish my name before God for ever: thy seed and thy name will stand throughout all generations of the earth."

25. And he ceased commanding him and blessing him. 26. And the two lay together on one bed, and Jacob slept in the bosom of Abraham, his father's father and he kissed him seven times, and his affection and his

21. *Day of judgment.* Cf. xxiii. 11, "day of the great judgment": xxiv. 28, "day of wrath and indignation": also xxxvi. 10.

22. *The profane.* Še'ûlân = βεβηλωμένοι (cf. Lev. xxi. 7, 14), emended from šelû'ân (*a b d*) = "the hated ones." *c* reads, "the perverse." If we emend *a b d* into šalâ-ējân we should have "the adversaries."

(e) *And there will be no remembrance,* etc. It will be observed that I have

transposed this verse on account of the parallelism.

They will descend into Sheol . . . will they go. The same passage with a transposition of the two verbs has already occurred in vii. 29 (see note): cf. Eth. En. ciii. 7, 8.

24. [*It is given, etc.*] A dittography from the second clause following.

25. *Commanding.* Gen. xlix. 33. This word goes back to צוה which is used technically of a man's last will